Migration and Fertility Dynamics

Preliminary Progress

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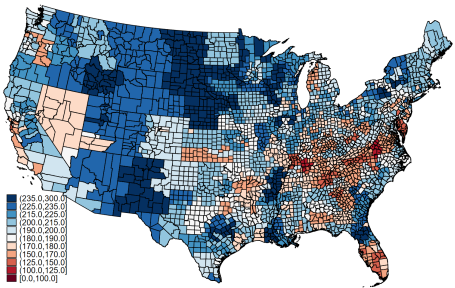
Can migration change fertility in receiving countries?

Cultural/demographic channel

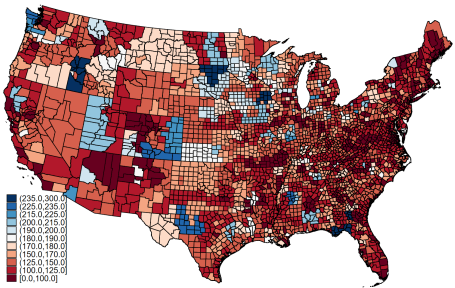
Migrants bring demographic characteristics that could affect local fertility through composition and cultural diffusion.

Local labor-market channel

Immigration changes labor supply and local economic conditions, which could influence residents' fertility decisions.



1970



2010

US county-level implied fertility measure for women aged 25 to 29 years. TFR lower in counties with lower migrant-origin population share; IPUMS-based calculations.

Measurement and empirical progress

Data Assembled

- County-level fertility proxies constructed from historical IPUMS data.
- Origin-specific migration or ancestry exposures for US counties.
- Preliminary county regressions and push–pull/ancestry-based approaches.

Exposure Measures

Difussion: Origin-fertility-weighted migration

$$F_c = \frac{\sum_o m_{oc,1970}\, TFR_{o,1960}}{Pop_{c,1960}}$$

Labor Supply: Migration intensity

$$M_c = \frac{\sum_o m_{oc,1970}}{Pop_{c,1960}}$$

Preliminary Results: Fertility

Table: Dependent Variable: $TFR_{c,year} - TFR_{c,1970}$

	All Individuals			Only US-Born Citizens		
	1980	1990	2010	1980	1990	2010
Diffusion (Mig. TFR origin 1960)	-0.048	0.069	0.659**	-1.441***	-1.828***	-0.555
	(0.144)	(0.165)	(0.258)	(0.505)	(0.520)	(0.796)
Labor Supply (Mig)	0.731***	1.246***	1.198***	-0.739**	-1.563***	-5.763***
	(0.092)	(0.105)	(0.164)	(0.321)	(0.331)	(0.507)
Observations	3135	3141	3137	3135	3141	3137
R-squared	0.025	0.056	0.029	0.008	0.021	0.054
Underidentification Test	2836.626	2842.230	2838.563	2836.826	2842.230	2838.563
Cragg-Donald Wald F-Stat	14899	14926	14904	14899	14926	14904

Standard errors in parentheses.
$^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$

Preliminary Results: Wages and Labor Force Participation

Table: Dependent variable in changes relative to 1970

	Labor Participation			Log Inc. Wage		
	1980	1990	2010	1980	1990	2010
Panel A. Females						
Diffusion (Mig, TFR origin 1960)	-0.001	-0.003***	-0.004***	-0.003	0.006	0.010**
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.004)
Labor Supply (Mig)	0.004***	0.002**	-0.001	-0.067***	-0.073***	-0.050***
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.003)	(0.003)	(0.003)
Observations	3135	3141	3137	3135	3141	3137
R-squared	0.018	0.008	0.009	0.185	0.202	0.122
Underidentification Test	2836.826	2842.230	2838.563	2836.826	2842.230	2838.563
Cragg-Donald Wald F-Stat	14898.912	14926.034	14904.408	14898.912	14926.034	14904.408
Panel B. Males						
Diffusion (Mig, TFR origin 1960)	-0.001	-0.003***	-0.005***	-0.009**	0.004	0.005
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.004)	(0.004)	(0.003)
Labor Supply (Mig)	-0.004***	-0.002***	0.002*	-0.065***	-0.073***	-0.048***
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)
Observations	3135	3141	3137	3135	3141	3137
R-squared	0.022	0.012	0.008	0.241	0.276	0.160
Underidentification Test	2836.826	2842.230	2838.563	2836.826	2842.230	2838.563
Cragg-Donald Wald F-Stat	14898.912	14926.034	14904.408	14898.912	14926.034	14904.408

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Summary of Preliminary Evidence

Heterogeneous demographic and labor-market adjustments to migration exposure.

Fertility

- Greater migration exposure is associated with **higher fertility** in the full sample, but **lower fertility** among US-born women.
- The relationship between origin-country fertility and local fertility is less consistent across periods and populations.

Labor Market

- Migration exposure is associated with **higher female** and **lower male** labor-force participation in earlier periods.
- Wage-income responses are negative and remarkably similar across genders.

Research Progress

- Constructed historical county-level fertility measures using IPUMS data.
- Assembled migration and ancestry exposure measures incorporating origin-country fertility.
- Estimated preliminary relationships between migration exposure and:
  - Fertility outcomes.
  - Wages and labor-force participation.
- Explored a push–pull identification strategy using historical migration and ancestry patterns.

Next Steps

Empirical Analysis

- Validate fertility measures and account for selection into migration.
- Refine the identification strategy and assess the validity of the proposed instruments.
- Distinguish fertility-norm diffusion from labor-market adjustment mechanisms.
- Extend the analysis across age groups and historical periods.

Planned Quantitative Analysis

- Develop a dynamic spatial model that links trade, migration, labor markets, and endogenous fertility to evaluate alternative migration policies.